

PRODUCT & PROGRAM EXECUTIVE REVIEW

Merchant Payment Operations & Dispute Hub

MVP business case, delivery status, and the decisions leadership needs to make now

PREPARED BY

Bhawna, Product Owner

KEY DOCUMENTS

PRD v1.2 · Roadmap v1.1

STATUS AS OF

10 September 2026

PLANNED GO-LIVE

11 December 2026

Simulation project: a Product Owner portfolio exercise. Not an actual client system; all figures are illustrative.

THE PROBLEM

Disputes run on email, deadlines get missed, and no one trusts the numbers

78%

On-time merchant response rate today

Target 95% • KPI-03

9%

Of closed disputes lost only because the deadline passed

Target 3% • KPI-04

42 min

Dispute Ops handling time per dispute

Target 25 min • KPI-05

100%

Of evidence still arrives by email

Target 70% via portal • KPI-06

Underneath the numbers

- Card numbers sit unmanaged in email attachments: an active PCI DSS exposure (R-02)
- Finance and Dispute Ops calculate win rate differently: 40% vs 62.5% on the same 100 disputes (I-05)
- Merchants can't see how disputes affect their payouts, so they contact servicing: 14 settlement queries per 100 merchants a month (KPI-07)

One self-service portal replaces the email-and-spreadsheet workflow

A portal where merchants track disputes, get deadline reminders and submit evidence online, so they stop losing disputes to missed deadlines and Dispute Ops stops processing everything by email.

TODAY

Notice: Email from Ops, sometimes missed

Understand: Look up the reason code or call servicing

Gather evidence: Collect files and email them to Ops

Respond: Ops re-keys evidence into the processor

Track: Chase Ops by email or phone

WITH THE DISPUTE HUB

Notice: Dispute appears in the inbox with its due date; reminders at 5 and 2 days

Understand: Plain-language reason with the evidence that usually wins

Gather evidence: Upload files; card numbers are redacted automatically

Respond: Submit in one step, or accept with a clear warning

Track: Status and 'last synced' time always visible

Dispute portals are table stakes; our edge is prevention and explainable AI

What discovery found, and how the Dispute Hub positions itself

What the market already offers

American Express

Online Disputes tool: see open and urgent disputes, upload documents, respond online, email alerts, reply-by dates

Adyen

Disputes list showing days left to defend and the latest event

Stripe

Smart Disputes builds evidence packets and submits them before the deadline if the merchant does nothing

Razorpay

Dashboard to accept or contest disputes with typed evidence, plus webhook updates

Where the Dispute Hub differentiates

MVP STRENGTHS

- Card numbers redacted on upload, with quarantine
- Settlement debits and reversals linked to disputes
- One agreed outcome definition for Finance and Ops
- Internal Ops workbench and feed-health alerts

BEYOND MVP (PROPOSED)

Next

Dispute ratio health, pre-dispute alerts, AI evidence copilot with human review

Later

Friendly fraud automation, root-cause insights, AI agent purchase readiness

Sources: Discovery & Decision Log v2.0 (DSC-06 to DSC-15; SRC-01 to SRC-20), accessed 11 Sep 2026. Positioning is for the simulation, not a claim about any provider's plans.

MVP scope at a glance

9

Epics

42

Backlog items

252

Story points

10

Two-week sprints

11 Dec 2026

Planned go-live

Nine MVP epics

EP-01 Merchant Access & Onboarding	28 pts	EP-02 Dispute Inbox & Tracking	32 pts	EP-03 Evidence Submission	45 pts
EP-04 Processor Integration	47 pts	EP-05 Notifications & Reminders	10 pts	EP-06 Settlement Visibility	19 pts
EP-07 Reporting & Analytics	23 pts	EP-08 Internal Ops Workbench	8 pts	EP-09 Platform Quality & Compliance	40 pts

Explicitly out of MVP scope

Fraud case management in the hub (a read-only reference is pending CR-01) · Spanish portal · SMS reminders · Marketplace sub-merchants · Reason code admin screen · Nightly data files · Automated dispute decisions · Prevention and AI capabilities (roadmap RM-25 to RM-30)

Sprint 4 of 10: 32% of MVP points complete

As of 10 September 2026 • 80 of 252 points • Sprints 1–3 delivered 69 of 69 planned points • 2 items blocked



Watch items

US-019 blocked

Status-update webhooks blocked by a processor sandbox issue (I-01)

US-034 blocked

Amplitude tracking waits for data governance approval (I-06)

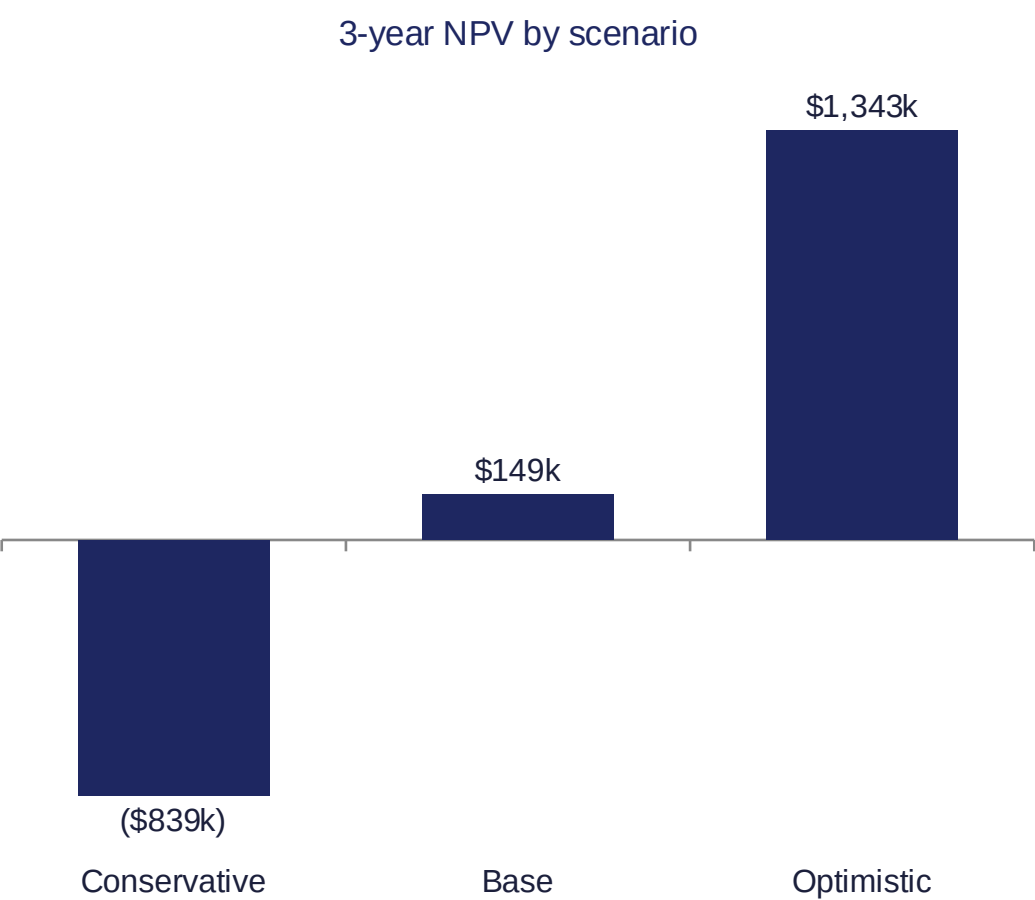
Evidence Submission at 11%

Largest remaining epic (45 pts), most exposed to the December go-live

3 epics not started

Notifications, Settlement Visibility, Reporting & Analytics: 52 pts

Base case is positive, but adoption and Ops capacity decide the outcome



	Conservative	Base	Optimistic
3-year NPV	(\$839k)	\$149k	\$1.34M
3-year ROI	(59%)	26%	138%
Payback after go-live	Beyond 3 yrs	2.3 yrs	1.2 yrs
Year 3 net cash flow	(\$13k)	\$477k	\$1.05M

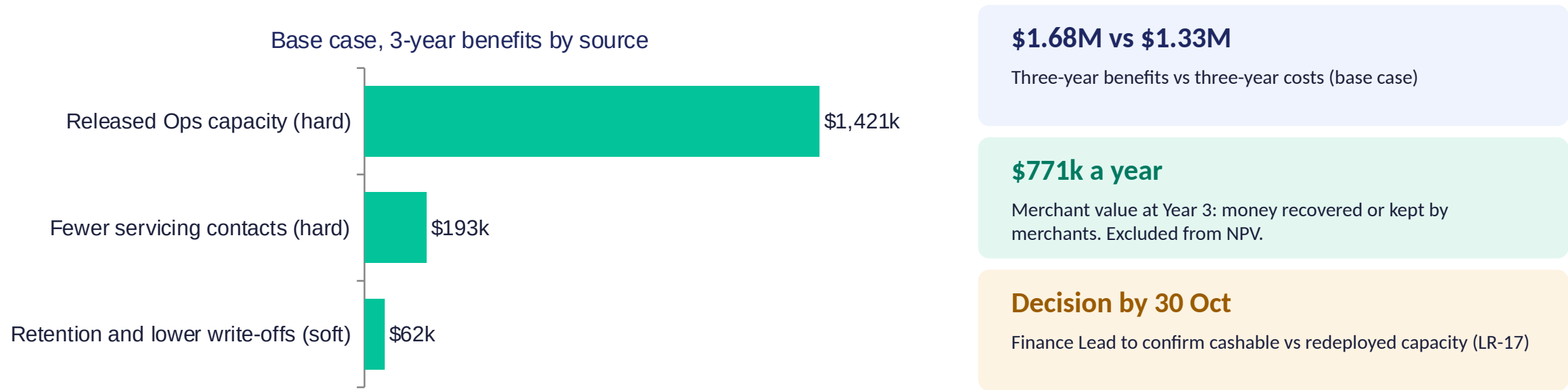
\$612k

One-time investment: build team, contingency, penetration test and accessibility audit

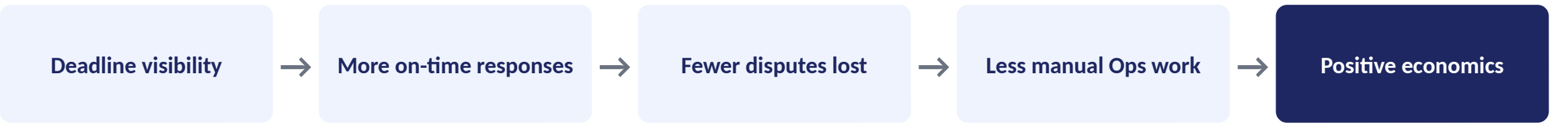
Conservative case loses money

Low adoption and redeployed rather than cashable capacity push NPV to (\$839k). That is why the pilot gates and LR-17 matter.

85% of base-case benefit is released Ops capacity: confirm whether it is cashable



How the value is created



Success metrics: end-2027 checkpoint and steady-state targets

Interim values follow the quarterly benefits path in the Post-Launch Plan, which rolls up to the base business case

Metric	Baseline	End of 2027	Steady-state target	KPI
On-time response rate	78%	91%	95% by end-2028	KPI-03
Missed-deadline loss rate	9%	5%	3% by end-2028	KPI-04
Ops handling time per dispute	42 min	29 min	25 min by end-2028	KPI-05
Portal evidence share	0%	55%	70% by 2029	KPI-06
Settlement contacts per 100 merchants	14	10	8 by end-2028	KPI-07
Dispute value recovery (North Star, pending CR-05)	38%	42%	45% by end-2028	KPI-01

Guardrails and leading indicator

0

Card data exposure incidents • KPI-16

≤ 5 min

Status sync latency, 95th percentile • KPI-12

≤ 0.5%

Settlement reconciliation variance • KPI-15

≥ 60%

Pilot merchant activation • KPI-08

Pilot-led rollout: each wave starts only when its gates are met

PHASE 0 Launch readiness Nov–Dec 2026 Internal teams Security, UAT, hardening Exit gate Go / no-go on 4 Dec	PHASE 1 Pilot Jan–Mar 2027 10 merchants Enterprise e-commerce Exit gate Activation ≥ 60%, on-time ≥ 90%, zero card data incidents	PHASE 2 Wave 1 Mar–May 2027 3,000 merchants ~62% of dispute volume Exit gate Portal share ≥ 35%, missed-deadline loss ≤ 5%	PHASE 3 Wave 2 Jun–Sep 2027 5,400 merchants ~88% of dispute volume Exit gate Portal share ≥ 50%, handling time ≤ 30 min	PHASE 4 General availability Oct–Dec 2027 24,900 merchants ~93% of dispute volume Exit gate Email intake retired for portal-enabled merchants
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Every expansion checks five gates

Adoption Activation and portal share on target	Outcomes On-time response trending to target	Security No open critical or high findings	Operations Capacity and support model ready	Data KPI tracking and reconciliation live
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Five open risks need executive visibility

R-04	Low merchant adoption of the portal	Pilot with 10 high-volume merchants; in-portal onboarding; adoption tracking; email retired wave by wave	Owner Product Owner	16 • High
R-02	Card numbers in evidence expand PCI DSS scope	Automated redaction on upload (CR-03); quarantine; InfoSec validation before UAT sign-off	Owner Tech Lead	15 • High
R-03	Status sync lag causes missed deadlines	Feed-freshness alerts; 'last synced' timestamp; reminders at 5 and 2 days	Owner Tech Lead	15 • High
R-01	Card network rule changes before go-live	Configurable reason codes and response windows (CR-02)	Owner Product Owner	12 • Medium
R-05	Legacy settlement data quality undermines reports	Data quality rules; exception report; reconciliation before sign-off	Owner Data Engineering Lead	12 • Medium

Scores are likelihood × impact on a 1–5 scale (RAID Log).

Change control is working, but schedule contingency is nearly used up

9 of 10

Contingency days used by approved changes

4

Change requests pending, of 9 logged (3 approved, 1 rejected, 1 deferred)

60%

Approval rate: 3 approved of 5 decided

5 Jan 2027

Forecast go-live if all pending changes are approved as requested (baseline 11 Dec 2026)

Recommended decisions

CR-01 • Fraud case scope

Keep full fraud case management out of MVP; add a read-only linked case reference (Option C), with a Phase 2 commitment.

CR-05 • Outcome definitions

Report Won, Partially won and Lost separately (Option C) and govern one definition before KPI reporting starts.

CR-06 • UAT approach

Run UAT in parallel with the delayed pen test only where Compliance and InfoSec controls allow; protect the go-live gate.

Protect the MVP baseline: treat any late scope as an explicit trade-off against the 11 December 2026 go-live.

Two vendor dependencies are already committed later than needed

0 of 19

Launch readiness items done so far; 14 are critical for the go-live gate

D-01 • Processor dispute API production access

Provider: Payment processor

At risk Needed 16 Oct • committed 23 Oct

D-03 • Penetration test before UAT

Provider: InfoSec

At risk Needed 30 Oct • committed 13 Nov

Go-live requires

✓ UAT sign-off

✓ Critical and high pen test findings fixed

✓ InfoSec redaction validation

✓ Load test passed at 3× peak

✓ Accessibility sign-off

✓ Dispute Ops and servicing trained

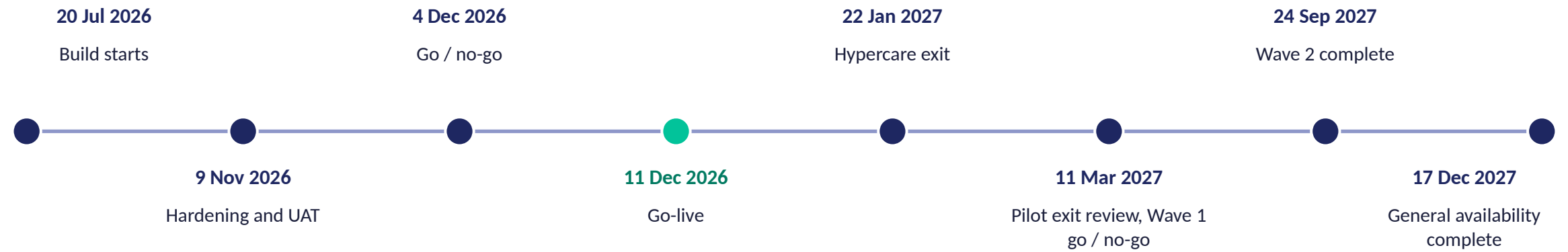
✓ Rollback plan tested

✓ Hypercare rota and KPI tracking ready

Hypercare 11 Dec 2026 – 22 Jan 2027. Exit is based on evidence, not the date: 10 consecutive business days with no open Sev 1 or Sev 2, sync latency p95 ≤ 5 min, zero card data incidents, runbooks accepted, and support running without the delivery team.

TIMELINE

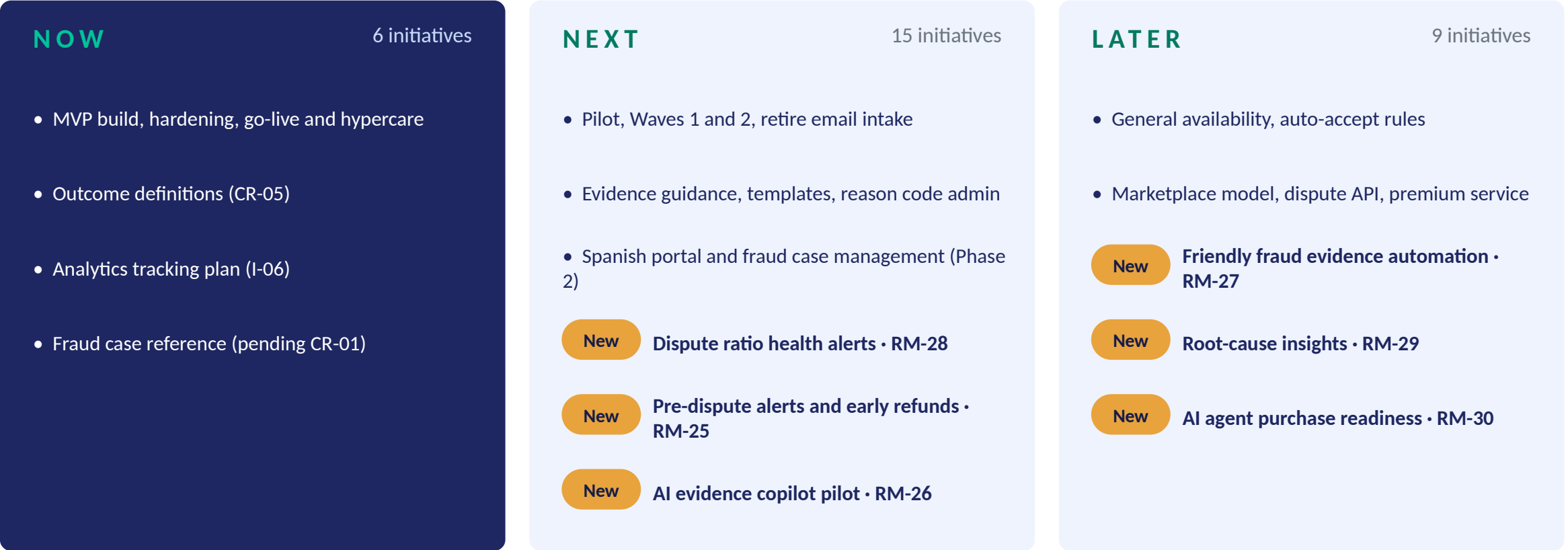
From build to general availability



Dark cards: phases in progress or next. The pilot runs inside hypercare; its exit review on 11 March decides Wave 1.

MVP is the foundation; the destination is dispute prevention

30 initiatives on Product Roadmap v1.1 • horizons measured from 11 September 2026



New = proposed from the Discovery & Decision Log. Each needs discovery, compliance review and a business case; the AI copilot also needs a model risk review (17 Jun 2027).

Five decisions leadership needs to make

Decision	Approver	Needed by
CR-05 Approve dispute outcome and win-rate definitions	Business Sponsor	18 Sep 2026
CR-01 Decide fraud case management scope for the MVP	Steering Committee	24 Sep 2026
CR-06 Approve running UAT in parallel with the delayed pen test	Steering Committee	25 Sep 2026
I-06 Approve the analytics tracking plan, needed to measure pilot activation	Data Governance Lead	1 Oct 2026
LR-17 Agree treatment of released Ops capacity: cashable or redeployed	Finance Lead	30 Oct 2026

Four decisions fall due by 1 October; the capacity decision (LR-17) is due 30 October.

RECOMMENDATION

Endorse the base case, clear four decisions by 1 October, and the capacity decision by 30 October

- 1 Endorse the base-case investment (\$149k NPV, 26% ROI, 2.3-year payback), noting the conservative case is negative
- 2 Approve the pilot-led rollout, with its KPI exit gates as go / no-go criteria for each wave
- 3 Resolve CR-05, CR-01, CR-06 and I-06 by 1 October, and LR-17 by 30 October
- 4 Help unblock the two at-risk dependencies: processor production access (D-01) and the InfoSec penetration test (D-03)

Next governance touchpoint: Steering Committee, 24 September 2026

Supporting detail: PRD v1.2 • Product Roadmap v1.1 • KPI Definitions v1.1 • Discovery & Decision Log v2.0 • RAID Log • Change Log • RTM • Business Case & GTM • Engagement Plan • Post-Launch Plan • Wireframes v1.1

Simulation project: a Product Owner portfolio exercise. Not an actual client system.